Source A - Count Kalergi
‘This is the European Question: the mutual hate of the Europeans that poisons the atmosphere. (....) The biggest obstacle to the accomplishment of the United States of Europe is the one thousand years old rivalry between the two most populated nations of Pan-Europe: Germany and France...’
Richard Coudenhove-Kalergi (Left) Pan-Europa 1923

Source B - Aristide Briand
‘I believe that a sort of federal bond should exist between the nations geographically gathered as Europe countries; these nations should, at any moment, have the possibility of establishing contact, of discussing their interests, of adopting common resolutions, of creating amongst themselves a bond of solidarity’
During the war, a number of federal proposals emerged, suggesting different forms of cooperation between European countries. Jean Monnet had suggested a political union between the UK and France. A 'European Union of Federalists' was formed in 1943. Winston Churchill, Prime Minister of the UK in 1943, called for a Council of Europe after the war.
In 1944, the resistance movements that had fought against the Nazis met in Geneva: they called for a federal state of Europe:

Source C - Europe speaks: issues on behalf of the ISK, *Internationaler Sozialistischer Kampfbund* (Militant Socialist International)
‘The Federal Union must be based upon a declaration of civil, political and economic rights which would guarantee democratic institutions and the free development of the human personality, and upon a declaration of the rights of minorities to have as much autonomy as is compatible with the integrity of the national States to which they belong… But in view of the failure of the League of Nations, the States must… surrender to the Federation their sovereign rights in the sphere of defence, relations with powers outside the Union, international exchange and communications.

POSSIBLE ANSWER

The excerpts trace the early origins of the European integration project before and during WWII, showing that the idea of a united, cooperative Europe long predates 1950.

First, it introduces **Richard Coudenhove-Kalergi** and the **Pan-European Movement** (1923–1926), which argued that Europe needed unity to end its destructive rivalries, especially the deep-rooted hostility between France and Germany

Then it describes **Aristide Briand’s 1929 proposal** to the League of Nations, advocating a federation of European states based on solidarity, dialogue, and shared economic and political decisions — an early call for structured cooperation among European nations

During WWII, various resistance and intellectual groups also imagined a **federal Europe**. The 1944 ISK text (Source C) insisted that European states must give up some sovereign powers — especially in defence and foreign affairs — to a common

federal authority that would protect rights, democracy, minorities, and peace. It even proposed that the federation have its own government and army, rather than relying on national forces

Together, the sources reveal a continuum of ideas: from interwar intellectual movements → wartime federalist proposals → post-war political speeches. All emphasise the need to overcome nationalism and rivalry to secure peace, prosperity, and democracy in Europe.

Activity 1 – Explain Kalergi's idea: "United States of Europe"

Kalergi's idea of a "United States of Europe" referred to a political union in which European countries would cooperate closely enough to prevent future wars. He saw European hatred and rivalry — especially the long-standing hostility between France and Germany — as the main barrier to achieving this unity. Unless these two nations overcame their mutual distrust, no European federation would be possible.

Activity 2 – Compare and contrast Sources B and C

Both Sources B and C imagine European countries cooperating more closely, but they differ in scope and ambition. Briand (Source B) proposes a looser federation, focused on regular contact, shared decisions, and solidarity to promote prosperity; it is cooperative but still respects national sovereignty. In contrast, Source C argues for a strong federal union with real power: a government directly responsible to citizens, control over defence and foreign policy, and even a single European army. While Briand sees integration as coordination among states, Source C sees it as a supranational authority to prevent future conflicts.